Coastal Risk Review. Rising sea levels now pose a serious threat to coastal infrastructure across the developing world. Storm surges that once arrived every fifty years are projected to occur every decade by the middle of the century. Municipal drainage networks were designed for a climate that no longer exists, and retrofitting them is costly. Adaptation planning works best when engineers, ecologists and residents agree on which places must be defended and which can be allowed to change. Mangrove restoration has emerged as a low cost buffer that also supports fisheries and stores carbon. Insurance markets are already withdrawing from the most exposed districts, leaving households to carry the risk alone. Managed retreat remains politically difficult because it asks communities to abandon land their families have held for generations. Further work is needed on financing mechanisms for small island states. Further work is needed on financing mechanisms for small island states. Further work is needed on financing mechanisms for small island states.